

CARVE A NICHE (clockwise from far left) Stylish living room; tranquil terrace lounge; a sculpted ceiling, marble finishes and bespoke marble table can be found in the dining room; the gathering hall



FACT FILE

Project Name Vortex 21

Firm Neelesh Chopda Architecture

Gross Built Area 32,000 sq ft

Location Betul, Madhya Pradesh

Lead Architects Ajit Gavhane, Darshan Jana, Aishwarya Pandit and Purnakshi Jagetia

Above 12 metres, marble panels glow softly with sunlight, filtering warmth and wonder through every room.

The facade system prioritises performance alongside beauty. Early explorations into glass and metal were set aside for marble—a non-porous, sound-insulating, dust-resistant material that diffuses the harsh east-facing light. The bungalow stands tall crossing the skyline of the town, sunlight piercing the bungalow. The marble's natural translucence captures and refracts light, revealing the crystalline textures within and creating a poetic interplay between exterior and interior. Designed as a "floating skin", the marble facade sits 10 ft away from the structural slab, allowing west light to seep through in the afternoon, resulting in a dynamic and multidimensional elevation.

More than just a house, this is a civic sculpture. It's a symbol of ambition, culture, and the kind of architectural audacity small towns rarely get. It breathes, it glows, and it just might get Betul a pin on the design map.